

Offline maps & route planning

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QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Save maps before service fails, write down your destination and at least one alternative, and check the actual route against current hazards. An offline map does not show live closures, fighting, damaged bridges or flooding. GPS position may still work without data, but accuracy and battery life are not guaranteed.

Do now.

- ☐ **Download before the outage**
01 Use the map app's offline feature for the whole journey, not just the destination. Test it with mobile data off.
- ☐ **Keep a paper backup**
02 Write addresses, landmarks, route choices and emergency contacts. Carry a paper map if available.
- ☐ **Check route suitability**
03 Consider flood zones, damaged structures, access needs and transport restrictions. The fastest app route is not necessarily the safest.
- ☐ **Conserve device power**
04 Reduce unnecessary screen use and keep a power bank available. Know how to view the downloaded map without needing a new connection.
- ☐ **Reassess as conditions change**
05 Stop in a safe place to compare the route with visible conditions and recent trusted reports. Do not enter an uncertain road simply because the map displays it.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use known routes and written landmarks while checking conditions from safe positions. If you cannot identify a safe onward route, reassess rather than consuming the last battery on repeated rerouting.

Watch for.

Maps and position tools are aids, not proof of safe passage. Avoid unfamiliar shortcuts through hazardous or recently fought-over ground.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group

Next decision.

Practise following a short route with the backup information. Include a destination you can reach on foot only if that is realistic for the household and conditions.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

National Park Service · Hiking safety

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/offline-maps/>